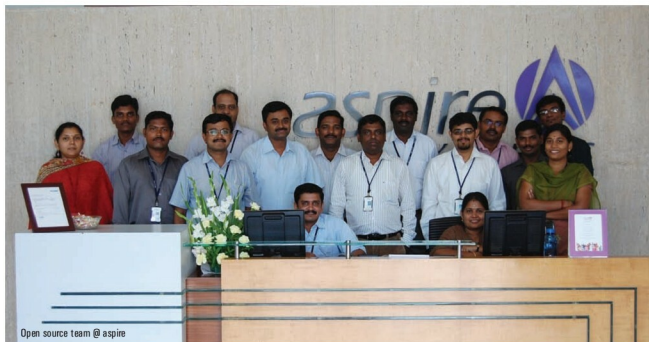




and posted it for others to use. The open source CoE at Sonata Software enhanced the OSRMT as per the GPL for the generation of a requirement traceability matrix.

An ever-expanding knowledge base

Stagnation is something every professional fears. But for developers thinking of a career in open source, constant learning is a promise this fast changing technology offers. Companies conduct extensive training programmes to help developers remain up to date with the latest. Internal training sessions and self-learning is the route some companies like Aspire and Agriya follow. "We provide an open source training framework for every new entrant in the open source team. The 6-8 week training programme helps them learn about Web concepts, PHP, ROR and Python. Further, to upgrade the skillsets and knowledge of the present team, we conduct Wisdom Curve sessions, during which the latest technology trends are identified and presented to the team," says Muralidharan.

"We believe in making our human resources self-reliant and self-dependant. Most of the training provided is on the job, wherein the seniors mentor freshers and encourage them to solve issues. Basic open source tools and Subversion are some training sessions provided to them. For upgradation of skillsets, we encourage our developers to watch and learn from videos, tech sites, tech blogs and discussion threads," says Kumar.

A mix and match of self-learning and external exposure is what e-con Systems relies on. "We believe in self-learning and thus, encourage our developers to pursue R&D with seniors to mentor them. We give all freshers basic training for three months and then put them in projects below the R&D experts. Also,

we encourage them to take part in conferences and workshops to gain exposure to the latest trends in the open source market. Recently, we sent our people to an Android workshop by TI. We allow our developers to identify workshops or training programmes they wish to attend and if there is interest shown by a few others, we send them," says Veerabahu. As Harry S Truman rightly said, "It is what you learn after you 'know it all,' that counts." With a strategy of constant learning in place, developers thinking of a career in open source are sure not to be let down on the learning and growth front!

What does the crystal ball say?

In the future, the IT and electronics industry will look towards the open source developers and the community to resolve technological hitches. "We are looking for mobile solutions and security infrastructure management solutions from the community. We are also looking at more avenues to understand and use the open cloud," says Muralidharan. Agriya hopes a mix of its developers and the community can crack the security challenge it faces using open source for product development, while e-con Systems looks for more interoperability in the years to come.

So, with constant efforts being made to improve platforms and tools, the future for professionals planning a career in open source is expected to only get brighter in the years to come. Who knows, the collaboration between many great minds might soon outsmart even the giant Apple! 

By: Vanisha Joseph

The author loves to experiment, and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment—so beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.